

Sumit Kumar Jatwar

Predoctoral Research Fellow, Information Systems Area, Indian Institute of Management Bangalore
113, PhD Students' Cubicle, IIM Bangalore, Bengaluru, India

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Research Interests

Human-AI Interaction, Trustworthy AI, Explainable AI, Trust and Reliance on AI Systems, Human Behaviour and Decision-Making, Financial Inclusion and Digital Payments, User Engagement with Intelligent Systems, Technology Adoption.

Education

- **Indian Institute of Management Bangalore** Bengaluru, India
Predoctoral Research Fellow 2026 – 2027
Research Focus: Human-AI Interaction, Trustworthy AI, Human Behaviour and Decision-Making
Relevant Coursework: Econometrics, Quantitative Research Methods, Research Methodology
- **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT ISM) Dhanbad** Dhanbad, India
Master of Business Administration (MBA), Business Analytics 2020 – 2022
- **International Institute of Information Technology (IIIT) Naya Raipur** Naya Raipur, India
Bachelor of Technology (B.Tech.), Computer Science and Engineering 2015 – 2019

Research Papers

- Jatwar, S. K. *Beyond Access: How Gender and Geography Jointly Shape Digital Payment Inclusion in India*. Completed Research Paper, **under review** at the 3rd India Conference on Information Systems (InCIS 2027), Track 09.
Summary: Using Global Findex 2025 microdata on Indian mobile phone owners, the study examines whether gender and rural residence act as independent barriers to active digital payment use, and finds the gender gap is widest among urban women and substantially attenuated in rural India. It also examines how exposure to digital-safety threats relates to usage.
- Jatwar, S. K. *Do Fans Trust the Machine? Acceptance of Automated and Human Video Refereeing Decisions in the FIFA World Cup*. Work in progress, target venue: ECIS 2027.
Summary: The study compares fan acceptance of machine-measured decisions (offside, goal-line) with human video judgement calls (penalties, handballs) across recent FIFA World Cups.

Current Research

Human-AI Interaction, Trust, and Decision-Making

- Investigating factors influencing trust, adoption, and reliance on AI-assisted systems.
- Examining behavioural responses to AI-generated recommendations and decision support.
- Studying human decision-making processes in AI-mediated environments.
- Exploring the role of explainability, transparency, and accountability in trustworthy AI.
- Analysing user engagement and interaction patterns with intelligent systems.

Research Experience

- **Robert Gordon University, IDEAS Research Lab** Aberdeen, UK (Onsite)
Research Fellow Dec 2018 – Jun 2019
 - Developed AI-enabled compliance management solutions for industrial environments.
 - Applied computer vision techniques for monitoring and decision-support applications.
 - Investigated augmented reality interfaces to improve human information engagement and decision-making.

- **Lancaster University, AI Lab** Lancaster, UK
Research Intern Jan 2019 – Jun 2019
 - Assisted in research on congestion control algorithms for robotic swarm systems.
 - Contributed to simulation and evaluation of distributed AI coordination methods.
- **Politecnico di Milano** Milan, Italy (Onsite)
Research Intern, Department of Electronics, Information and Bioengineering May 2018 – Jul 2018
 - Developed adaptive behavioural models for humanoid robots in interactive environments.
 - Applied machine learning techniques to improve human-robot interaction and user engagement.
 - Investigated real-time behavioural adaptation mechanisms for intelligent systems.

Industry and Entrepreneurial Experience

- **Annapurna Finance** Bhubaneswar, India
Data Scientist Jun 2022 – Apr 2026
 - Developed machine learning and predictive analytics solutions for large-scale financial decision-support systems.
 - Conducted behavioural analytics on over 3 million clients to understand repayment behaviour, credit risk, and decision-making patterns.
 - Developed a Probability of Default (PD) model for predicting loan delinquency and supporting risk management strategies.
 - Designed geographic risk-scoring models using socio-economic and financial indicators.
 - Built interactive dashboards and analytics tools to support data-driven organisational decision-making.
- **Azeedo Agritech Pvt. Ltd. (Incubated at NSRCEL, IIM Bangalore)** India
Founder Sep 2019 – Present
 - Founded an AI-driven agritech startup focused on intelligent decision-support systems for agriculture.
 - Led the development of machine learning, computer vision, and precision agriculture solutions for crop monitoring and farm management.
 - Directed multidisciplinary teams across technology development, product strategy, and business operations.
 - Secured incubation support, funding opportunities, and strategic partnerships through innovation and entrepreneurship programmes.
 - Conducted user-centric research to understand technology adoption and behavioural barriers in agricultural communities.
 - Designed and deployed AI-enabled solutions integrating analytics, automation, and digital technologies for sustainable farming.

Scholarships, Fellowships and Awards

- **NSR Predoctoral Fellowship**, IIM Bangalore, India 2026 – 2027
- **Tuition Fee Waiver (Government of India)**, IIT ISM Dhanbad, India 2020 – 2022
- **Research Fellowship**, Robert Gordon University, United Kingdom 2018 – 2019
- **Social Start-Up Fellowship Programme** 2018
- **Chief Minister Scholarship** – Full Tuition Fee Waiver, Undergraduate Studies, IIIT Naya Raipur
- **Startup Incubation Support**, NSRCEL (IIM Bangalore), AIC, and SSIP Gujarat
- **Finalist, CONTRIVE** (startup competition, 150 teams), Cognizance, IIT Roorkee 2017
- **Finalist, POSIDON** (Aqwabot competition), Cognizance, IIT Roorkee
- **Runner-up, Vigyaan** (Annual Technological Exhibition), NIT Raipur

Academic Projects and Thesis

- **Empowering AgriTech through Data Analytics and IoT**
Supervisor: Prof. K. S. Thyagaraj, IIT ISM Dhanbad Jul 2021 – Dec 2021

- **Predicting News Show Popularity using Machine Learning**
Supervisor: Dr. Shravan Trivedi, IIT ISM Dhanbad Jan 2021 – Jun 2021
- **Blockchain Technology in Healthcare**
Supervisor: Dr. Santosh Kumar, IIIT Naya Raipur Aug 2018 – Dec 2018
- **Smart Irrigation System using DIP and ML**
Supervisor: Dr. Venkanna U, IIIT Naya Raipur Aug 2018 – Dec 2018
- **Personal Assistant Robot**
Supervisor: Dr. Santosh Kumar, IIIT Naya Raipur Jan 2018 – Aug 2018
- **Traffic Management using Reinforcement Learning**
Supervisor: Dr. Muneendra Ojha, IIIT Naya Raipur Aug 2017 – Dec 2017
- **Design and Implementation of a Hardware-Based Defence System for Cloud Data Security**
Supervisor: Dr. Ramesh Vaddi, IIIT Naya Raipur Jan 2017 – May 2017

Seminars and Workshops

- **Climate Innovation Summit 2026**, IIM Bangalore, India 2026
- **2nd India Conference on Information Systems (InCIS 2026)**, IIM Ahmedabad, India 2026
- **Joint Italian-French Workshop (fNIRS)**, Politecnico di Milano, Italy
- **Symposium on Data Science and Business Analytics**
Talk by Prof. Dr. Artus Krohn-Grimberghe, University of Paderborn, Germany
- **IEEE Skill and Knowledge Enhancement Programme (SKEP)**, IIIT Naya Raipur, India
- **IEEE Skill and Knowledge Enhancement Programme**
Session by Dr. Anthony Lobo (Chair, IEEE Bombay), IIIT Naya Raipur, India

Mentorship Programmes

- **Economics Mentoring Program (EMP)** Harvard University, USA
Mentee 2026
– Mentored by Cashusa Wang, PhD student in Economics, Harvard University

Positions of Responsibility and Activities

- **Organiser**, TechNovate 2018 – Techno-Cultural Fest IIIT Naya Raipur, India
- **Event Management Team**, Concetto – Techno-Cultural Fest IIT ISM Dhanbad, India
- **Volunteer**, NGO Eride, teaching students in rural areas Chennai, India

Computer Skills

Languages	Python, Golang, SQL, JavaScript
Statistical Packages	R, STATA, Python statistical libraries
Machine Learning	Scikit-learn, PyTorch, TensorFlow, OpenCV
Development	React.js, Android Studio
Professional Software	Excel, Jupyter, Alteryx, Power BI, Git, LaTeX, ROS, Visual Studio
Hardware Prototyping	Xilinx FPGA, Arduino Uno, Raspberry Pi
Operating Systems	Unix/Linux, Windows, macOS

References

Dr. Santosh Kumar
Associate Professor, Computer Science
IIIT Naya Raipur, Chhattisgarh, India
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Prof. K. S. Thyagaraj
Professor, Management Studies
IIT ISM Dhanbad, Jharkhand, India
Email: thyagaraj@iitism.ac.in